

THE WHOLESALE PO REPORT · 2026 EDITION

Where CPG brands lose margin.

What the published record says about the distributors, deductions, deadlines and finance teams behind every wholesale order, and a working framework for brands in their first years of national distribution.

PREPARED BY

EasyOps

EVIDENCE BASE

26 cited sources

WRITTEN FOR

Founders, operators, controllers, sales leads

INSIDE

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- 04** Who owns the order: four people, one problem, and what finance leaders want from AI
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20%

of CPG revenue is spent on trade promotions, and 72% of U.S. promotions lose money¹¹

44 days

is how long a typical deduction stays unresolved¹⁷

60%

of brands get back less than half of what they dispute¹³

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FIVE TERMS YOU WILL SEE

Deduction. Money a customer subtracts from your invoice before paying. Also called a chargeback or a short pay.

Trade promotion. Any deal or discount you give a retailer or distributor to help sell your product.

Gross to net. The difference between the amount on the order and the amount that actually arrives.

OTIF (on time, in full). A retailer scorecard that measures whether your orders arrive when promised and complete.

Days deduction outstanding (DDO). How many days a deduction stays open before it is settled.

HOW TO READ THE NUMBERS

Every number has a small source number next to it. The full list is on pages 15 and 16. When the source is a company that sells software into this market, we say so, and you should treat that number as a rough guide rather than a hard fact.

Most of these studies looked at companies much bigger than a young brand. When we apply a big company rate to a \$5 million brand, we show the math and call it an illustration.

No EasyOps customer data appears anywhere in this report.

00

The money is lost after the order, not before it.

A purchase order looks like money in the bank. It is not. It is a promise to pay. The amount that arrives is almost always smaller than the amount on the order.

Here is what the published numbers say. CPG companies spend about **20 percent of their revenue** on trade promotions, meaning the deals and discounts they give retailers. In the United States, 72 percent of those promotions lose money¹¹. Mid-sized brands lose 3 to 7 percent of their sales to deductions, and each year they write off 1.2 to 2.4 percent of sales because the money never comes back¹². When brands dispute a deduction, 60 percent of them get back less than half of what they asked for¹³. A typical deduction stays unresolved for 44 days¹⁷.

Large manufacturers know all of this. They have teams whose only job is to handle deductions. A small brand does not. The brand that just signed with its first national distributor ships 50 to 200 orders a month and runs operations with one or two people. **It faces the same rules, the same fees and the same deadlines, with a fraction of the staff.**

This report collects what public sources say about that gap. It uses distributor financial filings, trade association surveys, benchmark studies and surveys of finance leaders, all published between 2018 and September 2026. Every number has a source. Where the publisher sells software, we say so.

The short version

- **Fewer companies control the door** to national retail, and smaller brands are winning shelf space through it^{2,4,7}.
- **Missing a delivery window has a price.** At Walmart it is 3 percent of the cost of the goods. A post audit gives you 15 days to respond^{14,15}.
- **Time is the cost.** Deductions stay open for weeks. Small ones are written off without a fight. Customers are taking longer to pay^{17,18,19}.
- **Finance leaders are adopting AI quickly**, and they trust it only when it can show its work^{20,21}.
- **The brands that keep their margin** treat each order as a job to run, not a document to file.

EASYOPS' TAKE

The purchase order is a static document. The work happens everywhere else.

It is far easier to lose the money than to stop it from leaking in the first place. Every number in this report says the same thing.

A senior operator once told me: I know which fires will burn the house down, and I let the others burn. That is the job at a small brand. This report is meant to help you tell the two apart.

Jordan Harper

Founder & CEO, EasyOps

01

The channel has already moved.

Two distributors are the door to national retail for natural, organic and specialty brands. More brands are coming through that door every year.

3.7%

growth in U.S. retail sales in 2025 compared with 2024

U.S. Census Bureau ¹

\$31.2B

UNFI's sales in fiscal 2026, down 2 percent from the year before

UNFI 8-K ²

\$76.6B

U.S. organic sales in 2025, up 6.8 percent

Organic Trade Association

A distributor buys products from brands and delivers them to stores. For natural and specialty food, two distributors matter most. UNFI delivers to about 30,000 store locations and buys from about 11,000 suppliers³. Its sales were \$31.2 billion in fiscal 2026². KeHE runs 19 warehouses, delivers to more than 30,000 stores and carries about 8,500 brands⁴.

Those numbers matter for a new brand. When **11,000 suppliers sell to one buyer**, that buyer writes the rules once and applies them to everyone. The delivery instructions, the fill rate target, the fee list and the deadline to dispute a charge are not negotiated brand by brand. They come with the deal. UNFI's supplier terms say it directly: invoices are paid net of any deductions, chargebacks and fees owed under its supplier policies¹⁶. In plain terms, the distributor subtracts what it thinks you owe before it pays you.

KeHE itself admits the fee list is complicated. It offers new suppliers under \$500,000 in their first year a flat 2 percent program that replaces several separate fees, such as new item fees and manufacturer chargeback fees⁵. A program like that exists because the standard fee structure is hard for a new brand to follow.

HOW BIG THE DOOR IS

UNFI store locations approx.		30,000
KeHE stores served more than		30,000
UNFI suppliers approx.		11,000
KeHE brands carried approx.		8,500

Sources ^{3,4}. Bars scaled to 30,000.

11,000 suppliers. One rulebook.

The distributor's delivery rules, fee list and dispute deadlines are written once and applied to every supplier at the warehouse door^{3,16}. For a brand in its first year, **the rules are the one part of the deal you cannot negotiate.**

01 · CONTINUED

Small brands are winning. Small teams are doing the work.

Circana studied more than 700 manufacturers for its 2025 Growth Leaders report. It found that **store brands and manufacturers under \$1 billion in sales gained market share** in 2025. Food and beverage sales grew 3 percent that year, and non-food grew 2 percent⁷. Organic grew twice as fast as the rest of the market: 6.8 percent against 3.4 percent⁶.

So growth is going to the companies with the fewest people to manage it. The big companies are cutting staff too. Deloitte surveyed 300 consumer products executives for its 2026 outlook. 74 percent said they are simplifying their organizations, and about half are cutting the number of products they sell⁹. 95 percent of retail executives expect trade policy, meaning tariffs, to raise their costs¹⁰. When SPINS asked CPG executives about agentic commerce, meaning AI tools that shop and order on a person's behalf, 46 percent called it very disruptive and only 11 percent felt ready for it⁸.

Every source points the same way. **More orders, from more brands, through fewer distributors, with higher costs and smaller teams.** The purchase order is where all of that lands.

74%

of consumer products companies are simplifying how they are organized

Deloitte ⁹

95%

of retail executives expect tariffs and trade policy to raise their costs

Deloitte ¹⁰

11%

of CPG executives feel ready for AI tools that shop on a person's behalf

SPINS ⁸

EASYOPS' TAKE

Scale is messy.

Every brand I meet at Expo West wants the KeHE or UNFI meeting. Almost none of them have read the supplier policy that meeting signs them up for.

Once your product reaches the distribution center receiving dock, that is when everything breaks loose. The order you celebrated becomes an appointment, a label spec, a case count and a deadline.

Getting in is the easy part.

Jordan Harper

Founder & CEO, EasyOps

02

The gross-to-net gap.

Gross is the amount on the order. Net is the amount that arrives in your bank account. This chapter is about the difference.

20%

of revenue is what CPG companies spend on trade promotions, the deals and discounts given to retailers

McKinsey ¹¹

72%

of U.S. trade promotions lose money (59 percent worldwide)

McKinsey ¹¹

EASYOPS' TAKE

Deduction tools are medication, not a cure.

Most deductions are contractual. You agreed to the promo. The check is short because the deal sheet said it would be.

The money worth fighting for is the slice where the deduction does not match the deal or the shipment. Find that slice fast, with the paperwork attached. That is the whole game.

Jordan Harper

Founder & CEO, EasyOps

A trade promotion is any deal a brand gives a retailer or distributor to move product: a temporary price cut, a coupon, a free case, a fee to get on the shelf. McKinsey estimates CPG companies spend **about 20 percent of their revenue** on these deals, one of the biggest lines on the income statement. 59 percent of promotions lose money worldwide, and 72 percent lose money in the United States. The best run promotions return five times more than the worst¹¹.

Promotions also create most of the paperwork. UpClear surveyed mid-sized CPG deduction teams in 2026. **Promotions were the number one type of deduction** by both count and dollar value, and the area teams most want to fix. Fines and penalties were the most common type of deduction that turned out to be wrong¹³.

Here is how it plays out. Your sales lead agrees to a deal: a discount, a free fill, a manufacturer chargeback (an MCB, where the distributor bills you for a promotion it ran on your behalf). Months later the check arrives short. The person matching the check to the invoice was not in the room when the deal was made, and often cannot find the paperwork.

#1

promotions are the most common deduction, by count and by dollars

UpClear, vendor ¹³

5x

what the best run promotions return compared with the worst

McKinsey

Fines

and penalties are the deduction type most often found to be wrong

UpClear, vendor ¹³

02 · CONTINUED

How much actually leaks.

3 to 7%

of sales lost to deductions at mid-sized CPG companies

Finortal, vendor ¹²

1.2 to 2.4%

of sales written off each year because the money was never recovered

Finortal, vendor ¹²

60%

of brands get back less than half of what they dispute

UpClear, vendor ¹³

~1%

deduction rate that the best run brands achieve

SPS Commerce

Finortal studied CPG companies with \$200 million to \$2 billion in sales. Deductions took **3 to 7 percent of gross sales**, with big differences depending on the sales channel. Each year those companies wrote off 1.2 to 2.4 percent of gross sales as deductions they could not recover¹². Finortal sells deduction software, so treat these numbers as a rough guide. They are also the only published numbers at this level of detail, which tells you how little of this gets measured in public.

SPS Commerce's accounting playbook for suppliers says **roughly 80 percent of off-invoice deductions in retail are shortage claims**, meaning the retailer says it received fewer cases than you billed for. Many of those claims are wrong. The best run brands keep total deductions to about 1 percent of gross sales¹⁴. Shortage disputes are won with shipping paperwork: the bill of lading (the carrier's receipt showing the case count), the signed proof of delivery, and the advance ship notice (the ASN, an electronic packing list you send before the truck arrives).

Now apply those rates to a small brand. At \$5 million in wholesale sales, 3 to 7 percent is \$150,000 to \$350,000 in deductions a year. Writing off 1.2 to 2.4 percent means \$60,000 to \$120,000 gone for good. The benchmarks come from companies with full deduction teams. **The exposure does not get smaller because your team is.**

\$60K to \$120K

written off each year at **\$5 million in wholesale sales**, if the mid-sized company rate holds. This is our arithmetic using source ¹². It is an illustration, not a published benchmark for brands this size.

03

The clock and the rulebook.

Retailers and distributors publish rules and charge fees when you break them. They also set deadlines for getting your money back.

3%

of the cost of the goods, charged on every case that misses Walmart's on time in full goal in a month

SupplierWiki ¹⁵

90 / 98 / 95

Walmart's targets, in percent: your own shipments on time, Walmart pickups ready, and orders shipped complete

SupplierWiki ¹⁵

15 days

to respond to a Walmart post audit claim, counted from the day the email arrives

SPS Commerce ¹⁴

Walmart's On Time In Full program, called OTIF, is the model most retailers copy. Each month it measures whether your orders arrived on time and complete. Miss the goal and Walmart charges **3 percent of the cost of the goods on every case that did not comply**. The goals are 90 percent on time for orders you ship yourself, 98 percent ready for orders Walmart picks up, and 95 percent shipped in full. There is no published minimum. One bad case is a fee¹⁵.

Distributors work the same way. UNFI pays invoices net of any deductions, chargebacks and fees owed under its supplier policies¹⁶. KeHE rolls its new supplier fees into a single 2 percent charge because the itemized list is long⁵.

Post audits come later and give you less time. A post audit is a review, often done by an outside firm, of payments from months or years ago, looking for money the retailer thinks it overpaid you. Walmart requires you to contact the auditor within 15 days of the email. It also charges a 10 percent handling fee on damaged product¹⁴. These claims can reach six figures¹⁴.

The rules are public. The problem is the clock. A two person team that learns a rule from the chargeback has already paid to learn it.

EASYOPS' TAKE

Buyers are hunting for reasons to say no. Distribution centers are hunting for reasons to charge.

Neither is personal. The rule was written for 11,000 suppliers and applied by a scanner.

Read the routing guide before the first order, not after the first fee. I have watched a \$30M brand eat \$50K in penalties on a rule that was sitting in a PDF they already had.

Jordan Harper

Founder & CEO, EasyOps

No floor.

Walmart publishes no minimum below which the OTIF charge does not apply¹⁵. **Miss the goal by one case in a month and you pay a fee**, calculated on every non-compliant case shipped that month.

03 · CONTINUED

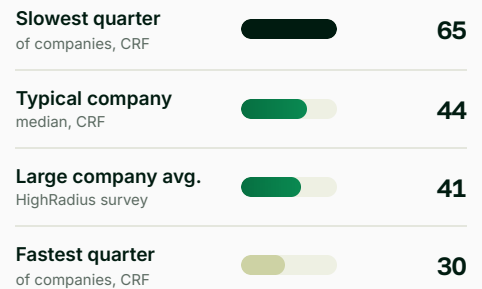
How long your money stays in dispute.

Days deduction outstanding, or DDO, is the number of days a deduction stays open before it is settled. The Credit Research Foundation surveyed companies across many industries. **The typical company took 44 days.** The slowest quarter of companies took 65 days or more. The fastest quarter took 30 days or less¹⁷. HighRadius, a software vendor, surveyed mostly large companies and found an average of 41 days to settle a dispute. One analyst clears about 20 deductions a day, and 68 percent of companies said their deduction volume was going up¹⁸.

Small amounts get written off without a fight. 87 percent of large companies automatically write off deductions below some dollar amount, and **76 percent write off anything up to \$100**¹⁸. For a large company that is a sensible policy. For a small brand, \$100 chargebacks across 150 orders a month are the margin.

Slow disputes also mean slow cash. The Hackett Group studied the 1,000 largest U.S. public companies in 2025. Days sales outstanding, the average time it takes to collect a payment, got worse for the second year in a row because customers used their bargaining power to stretch payment terms. The gap between the best collectors and the typical company was 18 days, worth \$600 billion in cash across the group¹⁹. An open deduction is money you have earned but cannot use.

DAYS A DEDUCTION STAYS OPEN



Sources ^{17,18}. Bars scaled to 65 days.

76%

of large companies automatically write off deductions up to \$100

HighRadius ¹⁸

18 days

faster: how much sooner the best companies collect than the typical company

Hackett ¹⁹

04

Who owns the order?

Four people at a brand feel the same order go wrong in four different ways. None of them can see the whole picture.

FOUNDER OR CEO

Do I know what is happening with my orders without asking three people?

You are protecting margin and trying to stay on the shelf. The order is the unit of your business, and it lives in someone else's inbox.

COO OR VP OPERATIONS

What is at risk today and who owns the next step?

Order confirmations, delivery appointments, labels, ship notices and deadlines, often handled by a third party warehouse (a 3PL) that is paid for speed, not for following the retailer's rules.

CFO OR CONTROLLER

Why did the check come in short and where is the margin going?

You invoiced \$32,000 and received \$21,000. The payment note references a promotion nobody can find the paperwork for.

HEAD OF SALES

Can I answer the buyer without digging through email and the portal?

The sale did not stick because the shipment broke a rule, and the buyer's trust went with it. Every chargeback question comes to sales first.

Large companies have the same problem. In UpClear's 2026 survey, **teams could not agree on what role sales should play in deductions**, so useful context never reached the people filing the disputes¹³. SPS Commerce's playbook lists six departments that touch a single deduction and recommends weekly meetings just to keep them aligned¹⁴.

This is not a people problem. It is a record problem. When the deal sheet, the order, the shipment, the delivery proof and the deduction sit in five different systems, nobody can answer the question before the dispute deadline passes.

EASYOPS' TAKE

Four personas, one pain: no single source of truth.

The salesperson finds out from the buyer. The controller finds out from the check. Ops finds out from both, then goes to rebuild what happened four months ago from email.

Turning a purchase order into cash is a team sport played with no scoreboard.

Jordan Harper

Founder & CEO, EasyOps

04 · CONTINUED

What finance leaders want before they trust AI.

75%

of finance departments now use AI, up from 30 percent in 2024

KPMG

43%

of North American CFOs feel confident in how their company governs AI

Deloitte ²¹

42% vs 14%

confidence in expanding AI use: companies that can audit their AI, compared with those that cannot

KPMG ²⁰

Adoption is not the question anymore. KPMG surveyed 1,013 senior finance leaders in 2026. Active use of AI in finance rose from 30 percent to 75 percent in two years²⁰. Gartner puts AI use in finance at 59 percent²³. McKinsey found 88 percent of companies use AI somewhere in the business, though only about a third use it at scale²⁴. In Deloitte's late 2025 survey, 87 percent of North American CFOs expected AI to become part of the everyday machinery of finance in 2026, and 54 percent named AI agents a priority²².

Trust is the question. In Deloitte's mid 2026 survey, 59 percent of CFOs said their biggest challenge was moving fast on AI while managing the risk. Only 43 percent felt confident in their AI governance, and 43 percent said they could not see clearly which AI tools were in use²¹. KPMG found that companies that can produce an audit trail for what their AI did, and explain it, get three to six times the error reduction (33 percent versus 6 percent) and are three times as confident about expanding AI use (42 percent versus 14 percent)²⁰.

Getting the evidence right pays. Hackett's July 2026 benchmarks estimate that finance teams using AI well can cut order-to-cash process costs by 52 to 59 percent and **resolve disputes 43 percent faster**²⁵. And there are fewer people to do the work by hand: the number of accounting graduates fell 6.6 percent in the 2023 to 2024 school year, to 55,152²⁶.

EASYOPS' TAKE

AI agent employees are here. Take a breath.

The finance leaders in these surveys are asking for the same thing the distributors ask for: show me the receipt.

An AI agent that can explain which rule applied on the ship date, point to the document it came from, and show what it did is one a controller will let near the check. One that cannot is a chat window with a liability attached.

Jordan Harper

Founder & CEO, EasyOps

05

What to do about it.

Six steps for running orders with a one or two person team. They work in a spreadsheet. They work better in a system. They do not work in an inbox.

1 Make the purchase order the unit of work.

Attach every document, message and deadline to the order, not to an inbox. If you cannot find it from the PO number in under a minute, treat it as missing.

2 Read the rules before you ship the first order.

Get the distributor's supplier policy and each retailer's compliance guide. Write down every fee in dollars and every deadline in days. The 3 percent OTIF charge and the 15 day post audit window are published^{14,15}. Learn them from the PDF, not from the chargeback.

3 Collect your proof when you ship, not later.

Save the order confirmation, the delivery appointment, the ship notice, the bill of lading with the case count, photos of the pallets, and the signed delivery receipt. About 80 percent of off-invoice deductions are shortage claims, and shipping paperwork is how you win them¹⁴. Proof you go looking for after the deduction arrives is proof you usually no longer have.

4 Sort deductions into two piles: agreed and disputable.

Most deductions are deals you already agreed to. Put those aside. Score the rest by how likely they are wrong and how much money is at stake. Dispute the ones worth it before the deadline. Stop chasing the ones that cost more to dispute than they return.

5 Track two numbers every month.

First, deductions as a share of gross sales. The best brands are at about 1 percent¹⁴. Second, days deduction outstanding. The typical company is at 44 days and the fastest at 30¹⁷. If you only track one, track the days. Time is the one thing a small team can control.

6 Fix the cause, not just the charge.

Every dispute you win came from a process that failed once. Spend half your time getting the money back and half fixing what caused it¹⁴. A deduction you never receive is worth more than one you win.

05 · CONTINUED

What each person should ask this quarter.

FOUNDER OR CEO

Ask for one view

How many orders are open right now? What is at risk this week? What did we lose to deductions last month as a percent of sales? If those three answers take more than a day to pull together, the order is not on file anywhere.

COO OR VP OPERATIONS

Ask for the rulebook

Which distributor and retailer rules apply to each order and each warehouse? Which of those rules does our 3PL actually see? The incentives are split: the 3PL is paid for speed, and the brand pays the chargeback.

CFO OR CONTROLLER

Ask for the split

Of last quarter's deductions, how much did we agree to, how much was disputable, and how much did we dispute before the deadline? Then set the two monthly numbers from step 5 and share them with the team.

HEAD OF SALES

Ask for the answer

When a buyer forwards a chargeback, can you reply the same day with the order, the shipment and the rule that applied on the ship date? If not, the relationship is paying for the missing record.

The whole report in one paragraph

The problems in this report are not about whether a brand can make or sell its product. They are about what the brand has built to run the order once it exists. The demand is there. The rules are public. What separates brands that keep their margin from brands that give it back is simple. Is the purchase order a document that gets forwarded, or a job that gets run, with the proof attached as it happens and the deduction answered before the deadline?

The six steps do not require software. Do them in a spreadsheet if that is what you have. When 50 orders a month becomes 200, the spreadsheet will break. By then you will know exactly what to ask a system to do.

EASYOPS' TAKE

Most brands do not need more software. They need one place where the order is true.

Start with the six steps. Do them badly before you do them well.

Cash is oxygen at every brand under \$10 million. The fastest way to get more of it is to stop leaking it at the receiving dock.

Jordan Harper

Founder & CEO, EasyOps

METHODOLOGY

How we gathered the numbers.

What this report covers

This report pulls together published, third party data on what happens to a wholesale purchase order for a consumer packaged goods brand in the United States: how big the distributors and retailers are, what brands spend on promotions, what they lose to deductions and chargebacks, what compliance programs charge, how long disputes take, how long customers take to pay, and how finance leaders feel about AI. EasyOps compiled it in September 2026.

Where the numbers come from

Twenty six sources are cited, published between 2018 and September 2026. We preferred primary sources: securities filings and investor releases, the distributors' own published policies and web pages, trade association surveys, the Credit Research Foundation, and the finance leader surveys run by KPMG, Deloitte, Gartner, McKinsey and The Hackett Group. Each number was checked against the publisher's own page on September 16, 2026. Each one has a source number in the text and a link on pages 15 and 16.

Vendor data

Four sources come from companies that sell deduction management, revenue recovery or supply chain software: Finortal, UpClear, SPS Commerce and HighRadius. We label their numbers as vendor data wherever they appear. We use them because nobody independent publishes numbers at that level of detail. Treat them as a rough guide. We cite the SupplyPike SupplierWiki summary of Walmart's OTIF program because Walmart's own documentation is only available to suppliers who log in.

What to keep in mind

- Most of these studies looked at companies far larger than the young brands this report is written for. Where we apply a big company rate to a \$5 million brand, we show the math and call it an illustration.
- Survey results reflect who each publisher asked and when. We list sample sizes in the Sources section where the publisher gives them.
- The Credit Research Foundation numbers come from its 2018 survey. Newer surveys exist but are only available to members.
- No EasyOps customer or prospect data appears in this report. The EasyOps' Take panels are the author's professional opinion, not survey findings.

How to cite this report

EasyOps, *The Wholesale PO Report 2026: Where CPG brands lose margin*, September 2026. Please credit the underlying source listed on pages 15 and 16 for any individual number.

SOURCES · 1 OF 2

Every number, by source.

Sources 1 to 13. Vendor publications are labeled. All links checked September 16, 2026.

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<https://www2.census.gov/retail/releases/historical/marts/adv2512.pdf>
- 2 **United Natural Foods, Inc..** Fourth Quarter and Full Year Fiscal 2026 Results (Form 8-K exhibit, 2026). Full year net sales decreased 2.0 percent to \$31.2 billion.
<https://ir.unfi.com/news/press-release-details/2026/United-Natural-Foods-Inc--Reports-Fourth-Quarter-and-Full-Year-Fiscal-2026-Results/default.aspx>
- 3 **UNFI.** About Us. UNFI serves approximately 30,000 customer locations and 11,000 suppliers.
<https://www.unfi.com/about-us.html>
- 4 **KeHE Distributors.** About KeHE and Retailers pages. 19 distribution center network; more than 30,000 retailers; 8,500 brands.
<https://www.kehe.com/about/> · <https://www.kehe.com/retailers/>
- 5 **KeHE Distributors.** Suppliers. Opt-in 2 percent flat rate program for new and small suppliers under \$500k in their first year, covering new item introduction allowances, EP, MCB, lumper and new item setup fees.
<https://www.kehe.com/suppliers/>
- 6 **Organic Trade Association.** 2026 Organic Market Report press release. U.S. certified organic sales reached \$76.6 billion in 2025, up 6.8 percent, double the 3.4 percent growth of the comparable marketplace.
<https://ota.com/about-ota/press-releases/us-organic-marketplace-achieved-significant-growth-2025>
- 7 **Circana.** 2025 U.S. CPG Growth Leaders (analysis of 700+ manufacturers over \$100M). Private label and manufacturers under \$1 billion gained share; retail food and beverage grew 3 percent, non-food 2 percent.
<https://www.circana.com/post/circana-announces-2025-u-s-cpg-growth-leaders>
- 8 **SPINS.** 2026 CPG Outlook: Executive Pulse Survey (fielded November 2025). 46 percent of executives call agentic commerce very disruptive; 11 percent feel ready.
<https://www.spins.com/resources/report/2026-cpg-outlook-spins-executive-pulse-survey/>
- 9 **Deloitte.** 2026 Global Consumer Products Industry Outlook (300 executives). 74 percent simplifying organizational structures; two thirds growing through partnerships; about half rationalizing SKUs.
<https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/industries/consumer/perspectives/consumer-products-industry-global-outlook.html>
- 10 **Deloitte.** 2026 Global Retail Industry Outlook. 95 percent of surveyed retail executives expect global trade policies to push costs higher.
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- 11 **McKinsey & Company.** How analytics can drive growth in consumer-packaged-goods trade promotions. CPG companies invest about 20 percent of revenue in trade promotions; 59 percent of promotions lose money (72 percent in the United States); best in class promotions return five times the least efficient.
<https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/growth-marketing-and-sales/our-insights/how-analytics-can-drive-growth-in-consumer-packaged-goods-trade-promotions>
- 12 **Finortal (vendor benchmark).** CPG AR Benchmark Report: How Mid-Market Companies Compare on Deduction Recovery. Companies at \$200M to \$2B: deductions 3 to 7 percent of gross revenue; 1.2 to 2.4 percent of gross revenue written off annually to unrecovered deductions.
<https://www.finortal.com/resources/cpg-deductions-benchmark>
- 13 **UpClear (vendor survey).** CPG Deduction Practices Benchmark Report 2026 (April 2026, mid-market CPG deduction teams). Promotions ranked first by quantity and value; 60 percent of brands recover less than half of what they dispute; fines and penalties lead invalid deduction types; automation tops the 2026 agenda.
<https://upclear.com/cpg-deduction-benchmark-report-2026/>

SOURCES · 2 OF 2

Every number, by source.

Sources 14 to 26.

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ABOUT EASYOPS

Every wholesale purchase order, in one place.

EasyOps turns every wholesale purchase order into a live workspace. Orders come in from any retailer or distributor. You see what needs attention, follow each order from receipt to payment, and keep the systems, documents and conversations around it together in one place.

01

See every order in one place

Orders arrive by EDI, PDF or email and land in one workspace with status, shipments, tracking, labels, proof of delivery and the email and Slack threads that belong to them.

02

Ship by the rules, on time

Each distributor's and retailer's rules are mapped to each order and each warehouse. Confirmations, ship notices and deadlines show up before they turn into a fee.

03

Answer the deduction with proof

Every dispute packet points to the source document and the rule that applied on the ship date. Compliance and recovery are proof the system understands the order, not the reason to buy.

EasyOps is built for CPG brands with \$2 million to \$10 million in revenue, in their first years with a national distributor, handling 50 to 200 orders a month with a one or two person operations team. It works alongside the systems a brand already runs.

Talk to us about your **order-to-cash workflow.**

No upload, no audit, no data required to start the conversation.

tryeasyops.com

hello@tryeasyops.com